Computational Philology

WiSe 2026–27

Getting a corpus

https://github.com/UHH-Tamilex/CompPhil2026/blob/main/week1

https://github.com/BetaMasaheft/Works/

We will be searching with **VSCodium**: https://vscodium.com

Regular expressions

A pattern used to search (and replace) text.

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A pattern used to search (and replace) text.

- Wildcards
- Character classes
- Quantifiers
- Alternation

Wildcards

. matches any single character

`eva.eva`

evameva
eva eva
evadeva...

Wildcards

. matches any single character

`eva.eva`

evameva
eva eva
evadeva…

\s matches any single space character

`en̲r̲a\sāru`

en̲r̲a āru

Wildcards

. matches any single character

`eva.eva`

evameva
eva eva
evadeva...

\s matches any single space character

`en̲r̲a\sāru`

en̲r̲a āru

\w or **\S** matches any word (non-space) character

`b\wal ba`

bral ba
bsal ba
bdal ba...

Wildcards

\w or **\S** matches any word (non-space) character

`b\wal ba`

bral ba
bsal ba
bdal ba...

\S may work better with non-Latin scripts, but is broader than **\w**

`\Sንግል`

ድንግል
ደንግል
-ንግል...

Character classes

[ ] matches one out of a group of characters

`[bv]yākaraṇa`

byākaraṇa
vyākaraṇa

Character classes

[ ] matches one out of a group of characters

`[bv]yākaraṇa`	byākaraṇa vyākaraṇa
`h[auūṛ]ta`	hata huta hūta hṛta

Character classes

[ ] matches one out of a group of characters

[bv]yākaraṇa	byākaraṇa vyākaraṇa
h[auūṛ]ta	hata huta hūta hṛta
nā[l̤l̲l]i	nāḷi nāl̤i nāli

Character classes

[ ] matches one out of a group of characters

[bv]yākaraṇa	byākaraṇa vyākaraṇa
h[auūṛ]ta	hata huta hūta hṛta
nā[l̤l̲l]i	nāḷi nāl̤i nāli
[sz]hes so	shes so zhes so

Character classes

[ ] matches one out of a group of characters

[bv]yākaraṇa	byākaraṇa vyākaraṇa
h[auūṛ]ta	hata huta hūta hṛta
nā[l̤l̄l]i	nāḷi nāl̄i nāli
[sz]hes so	shes so zhes so
ཇཽ[ཏཐ]	ཇཽཏ ཇཽཐ

Character classes

[^] matches anything **but** the group

`pu[^ṇ]arcci`

pukarcci
puyarcci
pu arcci
~~puṇarcci~~

Quantifiers

? matches zero or one of the preceding character

```
bik?khu
```

bhikhu
bhikkhu

Quantifiers

? matches zero or one of the preceding character

`bhi**k**?khu`	bhikhu bhikkhu
`dharm**m**?a**ḥ**? ?kṣetre`	dharmakṣetre dharmmakṣetre dharmma kṣetre dharmmaḥ kṣetre…

Quantifiers

? matches zero or one of the preceding character

`bhik?khu`	bhikhu bhikkhu
`dharmm?aḥ? ?kṣetre`	dharmakṣetre dharmmakṣetre dharmma kṣetre dharmmaḥ kṣetre...
`pūm? ?nāṟu`	pūnāṟu pū nāṟu pūmnāṟu pūm nāṟu

Quantifiers

? matches zero or one of the preceding character

```
pa ?d ?ma dmar po
```

padma dmar po
pad ma dmar po
pa dma dmar po...

Quantifiers

? matches zero or one of the preceding character

`pa ?d ?ma dmar po`

padma dmar po
pad ma dmar po
pa dma dmar po...

ዓመታ?ት

ዓመት

ዓመታት

Quantifiers

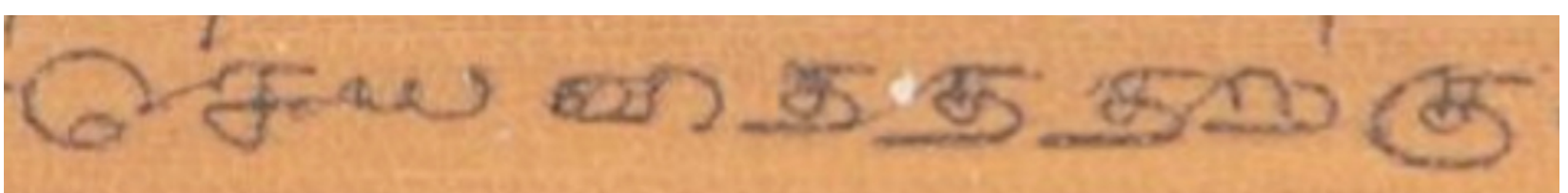
+ matches one or more of the preceding character

viñ+āṇa	viñāṇa viññāṇa viñññāṇa
nandiśarm+aṇa	nandiśarmaṇa nandiśarmmaṇa nandiśarmmmaṇa
ceyvit+aṟku	ceyvitaṟku ceyvittaṟku ceyvitttaṟku

Quantifiers

+ matches one or more of the preceding character

viñ+āṇa	viñāṇa viññāṇa viñññāṇa
nandiśarm+aṇa	nandiśarmaṇa nandiśarmmaṇa nandiśarmmmaṇa
ceyvit+aṟku	ceyvitaṟku ceyvittaṟku ceyvitttaṟku



BnF Indien 60 *Nālaṭiyar*, 67r, line 7.

Quantifiers

+ matches one or more of the preceding character

```
bat+sa la
```

batsa la
battsa la
batttsa la

```
bat\+sa la
```

bat+sa la

Quantifiers

{x,y} matches x–y of the preceding character

```
pra\S{1,5}chinna
```

pracchinna
praticchinna
prayātyachinna
prakārācchinna…

Quantifiers

{x,y} matches x–y of the preceding character

`pra\S{1,5}chinna`

pracchinna
praticchinna
prayātyachinna
prakārācchinna…

`vāḻi.{2,15}tōḻi`

~~vāḻi tōḻi~~
vāḻiyō tōḻi
vāḻiyō makaḷaiṉiṉ tōḻi
vāḻiya eṉat tōḻi
vāḻivēṇ ṭaṉṉai |eṉtōḻi

Quantifiers

{x,y} matches x–y of the preceding character

```
mkhan po.{1,10}kyi
```

mkhan po chos kyi
mkhan po rnams kyi
mkhan po gnyis kyi
mkhan po las dus kyi

Quantifiers

{x,y} matches x–y of the preceding character

`mkhan po.{1,10}kyi`

mkhan po chos kyi
mkhan po rnams kyi
mkhan po gnyis kyi
mkhan po las dus kyi

`[Bb]odhisatto.{2,50}agamāsi`

Bodhisatto puna agamāsi
Bodhisatto nhātvā agamāsi
Bodhisatto dānādīni puññāni karitvā yathākammaṃ agamāsi

Quantifiers

{x,y} matches x–y of the preceding character

`mkhan po.{1,10}kyi`

mkhan po chos kyi
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yathākammaṃ agamāsi

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Bodhisatto puna agamāsi
Bodhisatto nhātvā agamāsi

`[Bb]odhisatto[\S\s\n]{2,50}agamāsi`

Bodhisatto dānādīni puññāni karitvā
yathākammaṃ agamāsi

ተአምር.{1,30}ማርያም፡

ተአምር፡ ዘገብረት፡ ላቲ፡ እግዝእትነ፡ ማርያም፡

Alternation

(**xx**|**yy**) matches **xx** or **yy**

```
phun sum tshogs pa bs(grub|ag) pa
```

phun sum tshogs pa bsgrub pa
phun sum tshogs pa bsag pa

Alternation

(**xx**|**yy**) matches **xx** or **yy**

`phun sum tshogs pa bs(grub|ag) pa`

phun sum tshogs pa bsgrub pa
phun sum tshogs pa bsag pa

`sarīraṃ va(ṭṭ|tt|ddh)etvā`

sarīraṃ vaṭṭevā
sarīraṃ vattetvā
sarīraṃ vaddhetvā

Alternation

(**xx**|**yy**) matches **xx** or **yy**

`dharm(e|eṇa|ena|sya) kṣetr`

dharme kṣetr[e]
dharmeṇa kṣetr[e]
dharmena kṣetr[e]
dharmasya kṣetr[e]

Alternation

(xx|yy) matches **xx** or **yy**

dharm**(e|eṇa|ena|sya)** kṣetr	dharme kṣetr[e] dharmeṇa kṣetr[e] dharmena kṣetr[e] dharmasya kṣetr[e]
(perum?|irum?|ta[ṇṭ])pōtu	perupōtu perumpōtu irupōtu irumpōtu taṇpōtu taṭpōtu

More regular expressions

https://github.com/UHH-Tamilex/CompPhil2026/tree/main/week1

Next week

- discuss any issues/questions/successes/failures about regular expressions
- show & tell any monstrous regexes you've come up with

New stuff

- have a manuscript ready to transcribe
- check out the list of IIIF servers
  - https://github.com/UHH-Tamilex/CompPhil2026/tree/main/week2